

1701

WAR OF THE SPANISH SUCCESSION BEGINS

In 1701-13, France and Spain fought a Grand Alliance that included England, the Netherlands, and Austria over the Spanish crown. This had been left to Philip of Anjou, grandson of King Louis XIV of France after the death of Charles II of Spain.



△ Louis XIV proclaiming his grandson king

1709

FIRST USE OF COKE TO SMELT PIG IRON

Abraham Darby (1678-1717) transformed iron production by smelting iron ore with coke – a substance made from coal rather than charcoal. This fuelled the Industrial Revolution by allowing larger blast furnaces to be made and reducing Britain's reliance on rapidly disappearing woods for charcoal.



△ Iron production at blast furnaces in Coalbrookdale, Shropshire

1700

1704 Christian leader Dona Beatriz Kimpa Vita leads resistance to the Portuguese slave trade in the Kongo Empire

1708 Gobind Singh, the last human Sikh guru, is assassinated

1701 The Ashanti empire rises in modern-day Ghana

1700

NORTHERN WAR BEGINS

The Northern War (1700-21) began when Russia and its allies challenged the supremacy of the Swedish Empire in northern and eastern Europe. The Swedish emperor, Charles XII, defeated his opponents by 1706 and invaded Russia in 1707. He was beaten at the Battle of Poltava (1709) by the forces of Peter the Great, who drove the Swedes out of the Baltic region. The war ended with the Treaty of Nystad (1721), which gave Sweden's Baltic provinces to Russia.



▷ **Peter the Great**, painted by Paul Delaroche



△ **Aurangzeb**, Mughal Emperor

1707

DEATH OF AURANGZEB

The last of the Mughal Empire's great emperors, Aurangzeb (b. 1618), seized the throne from his father, Shah Jahan, in 1658, declaring himself "Conqueror of the World". He was a devout Muslim, and expanded the empire to its greatest extent, warring frequently with the Marathas. After his death, the Mughal Empire fragmented, but lasted in name until 1858.